

Loan Estimate comparison sheet

Every lender has to give you the same three-page Loan Estimate form within three business days of your application. Same form means you can compare line by line. Here's where to look.

What to compare	Where	Quote 1	Quote 2
Date issued and lock status	Page 1, top		
Loan amount, term and type	Page 1		
Interest rate	Page 1		
Monthly principal and interest	Page 1		
Prepayment penalty or balloon payment?	Page 1		
A. Origination charges (includes points)	Page 2		
B. Services you can't shop for	Page 2		
C. Services you can shop for	Page 2		
D. Total loan costs	Page 2		
Lender credits	Page 2, J		
Estimated cash to close	Page 2		
In 5 years: total paid and principal paid off	Page 3		
APR	Page 3		

How to compare fairly

- **Same day, same loan.** Rates move daily. Compare quotes issued close together, for the same loan amount, term and lock period.

- **Start with Section A.** That's what the lender charges. It's the cleanest apples-to-apples number.
- **Watch for points.** A lower rate with points in Section A isn't automatically better. Ask how long it takes to break even.
- **Sections E through H** are mostly taxes, prepaid interest, insurance and escrow. They shouldn't vary much between lenders, so don't let them decide.
- **Use the 5-year number on page 3** if you might sell or refinance within a few years.

Learn more about the form from the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau: consumerfinance.gov/owning-a-home/loan-estimate

Already have a quote? Get a second look.

Send me your Loan Estimate and I'll walk through it with you, line by line. No pressure. jaysoncain.com/schedule